

INTERNAL · V1.0 · 04 SEP 2026

Railway migration workflow & setup guide

A ten-day operating sequence for moving the AFÁRÁ application to Railway without losing the thread between infrastructure, data and the people who depend on it.

DECISION-READY

Owner-led

Rollback-aware

AT A GLANCE

10

working days

04

owner roles

24–48h

hypercare window

⚠

No cutover without a verified export, health check and named rollback owner.

THE OPERATING SEQUENCE

Select a workstream

01

Readiness

Day 1 · Audit & owners

>

02

Foundation

Days 2–3 · GitHub, Railway, Postgres

>

03

Migrate

Days 4–6 · Secrets, storage, data

>

04

Launch

Days 7–10 · Cutover & hypercare

>

DAY-BY-DAY RUNBOOK

Move in sequence. Prove each gate.

10 steps · 1 owner per decision

D01

GO / NO-GO

📄

Readiness & audit

Confirm repository access, current runtime, data inventory, vendor contacts and a named rollback owner. Freeze feature work after the audit.

✓

Production backup verified

✓

Domain / DNS access confirmed

✓

Rollback owner on-call



D02

FOUNDATION

GitHub + Railway setup

Connect the production repository to a Railway project. Pin the Node version, select the production branch and keep deploys manual until staging is green.

✓ Railway project + service created ✓ Branch protection enabled ✓ Build logs visible to team

OWNER · PLATFORM ENGINEER



D03

FOUNDATION

Provision Postgres

Add Railway Postgres in the same region as the application. Capture DATABASE_URL from the service reference, never from a chat message.

✓ DATABASE_URL resolves ✓ Connection limit reviewed ✓ Daily backups enabled

OWNER · DATA OWNER



D04

SECURITY

Variables & secrets

Add the inventory below to Railway Variables. Use separate staging values, rotate any copied credentials and do not commit .env files.

✓ All required variables present ✓ Production values reviewed ✓ Session secret rotated

OWNER · PLATFORM ENGINEER



D05

DECISION

Object-storage decision + copy

Inventory protected uploads in Replit Object Storage and legacy R2 paths, then copy required objects to the chosen S3-compatible store. Preserve keys and verify samples across file sizes.

✓ Destination recorded ✓ Object count reconciled ✓ Private read path tested

OWNER · PRODUCT + DATA OWNER



D06

VERIFY

Staging deployment

Deploy the pinned commit to a staging service. Run the smoke path: sign in, create a record, upload a file, send a callback, restart the service.

✓ Build and start both pass ✓ /api/health returns 200 ✓ Session survives restart

OWNER · PLATFORM ENGINEER



D07

MIGRATE

Export, import & checks

Put the source in maintenance mode, take a final export, restore into Railway Postgres and run startup migrations. Reconcile counts before opening staging.

✓ Export checksum recorded ✓ Migrations complete cleanly ✓ Users / applications reconcile

OWNER · DATA OWNER



D08

INTEGRATIONS

Provider callbacks & webhooks

Update callback, OAuth and webhook URLs at each provider. Verify raw-body handling where signatures are checked, then send one real delivery per integration.

✓ Callback URLs updated ✓ Webhook signature verified ✓ Duplicate delivery is idempotent

OWNER · INTEGRATIONS OWNER



D09

CUTOVER

DNS cutover

Lower TTL ahead of the window, confirm the Railway domain and then switch the canonical record. Keep the old service read-only until acceptance is signed.

✓ TTL lowered ✓ TLS certificate active ✓ Smoke test from external network

OWNER · MIGRATION LEAD



D10

24-48 HRS

Hypercare + rollback window

Watch health, error rate, queue latency, auth and uploads for 24-48 hours. Roll back if critical paths fail or data integrity cannot be explained quickly.

✓ On-call rota published ✓ Rollback command rehearsed ✓ Decision log closed

OWNER · ALL OWNERS

>_ RAILWAY SETTINGS

BUILD COMMAND

```
npm run build
```

START COMMAND

```
npm run start
```

HEALTH CHECK

```
/api/health
```



Listen on Railway **PORT** ; do not hard-code a port.

🛡️ NON-NEGOTIABLES

- ✅ Database-backed sessions via `connect-pg-simple` .
- ✅ Run startup migrations before accepting traffic.
- ✅ 50 MB JSON, form and upload body constraint.

🔒 SECRET INVENTORY

📄 Copy names

Names only. Values belong in Railway Variables.

`DATABASE_URL` `SESSION_SECRET` `APP_BASE_URL` `R2_ACCOUNT_ID` `R2_ACCESS_KEY_ID` `R2_SECRET_ACCESS_KEY` `R2_BUCKET_NAME` `R2_PUBLIC_URL`
`RESEND_API_KEY` `ZOOM_CLIENT_ID` `ZOOM_CLIENT_SECRET` `ZOOM_REDIRECT_URI` `ZOOM_WEBHOOK_SECRET_TOKEN` `AI_INTEGRATIONS_OPENAI_API_KEY`
`AI_INTEGRATIONS_OPENAI_BASE_URL`

⚠️ ROLLBACK TRIGGERS

Rollback immediately for sustained 5xx errors, failed sign-in or callbacks, missing uploads, session loss after restart, or any unexplained data mismatch.

🚩 **Keep source read-only through acceptance.**

AFÁRÁ operations · Internal planning document · Owner: migration lead

📄 Prepared for a calm, observable cutover